

Statement Fellowship — Form

Answers (Copy-Paste Ready)

Each answer is written to the exact field format and word limit.

Section 1 — Identity and background

Full name: Sage Clokey

Email address: scokey@studentsforliberty.org

Country of residence: United States

Country of citizenship: United States

Age band: 22-25

Gender: Male

LinkedIn URL or personal website: <https://sage-clokey.github.io/Living-works-by-the-word/>

Section 2 — Background and leadership signals

Current role / occupation: State Director, Students For Liberty — California. Building a bioregion-based campus network connecting STEM students to the principles of voluntary order through biology, not ideology.

Highest level of education completed: B.S. Bioinformatics, University of California Santa Cruz, 2026.

Years of professional or operational experience: 2-5 years

Sector or domain you primarily operate in: Activism or Movement

SFL involvement / story [100 words]: Started with SFL in early 2026 as California State Director during my final quarter at UC Santa Cruz. Current role: State Director (coordinator level). Built the California operation from scratch — 90-day bioregion strategy, Socratic event format (“Is Nature Libertarian?”), tabling playbook, LC onboarding guide, outreach pipeline, and contact log. Previously served as Young Americans for Liberty State Chair for California (April-June 2025). In July 2026 I completed a two-week chain trip — FreedomFest (Las Vegas),

Approaching Humanity (Phoenix), FEE Summer Campus (Maryland), and YALCON (Cincinnati) — cross-pollinating the liberty network across four states in fourteen days.

Other fellowships, accelerators, or formal leadership programs you have completed: Young Americans for Liberty State Chair, California (April-June 2025). Applying to Stossel Fellowship (Reason/Stossel TV, 2026).

Three measurable outcomes you have delivered in the last three years [3 lines]: 1. Wrote and completed a 100+ chapter trilogy (The Living Age Trilogy) connecting Austrian economics to molecular biology — three books totaling over 300,000 words, structured and drafted in under six months. 2. Authored “Genomic Ledger Synthesis,” a capstone research paper at UCSC proposing a distributed framework for eukaryotic genome construction using Hayek’s knowledge problem applied to synthetic biology. 3. Built the full SFL California State Director infrastructure from zero in 60 days: strategy document, four event templates, tabling playbook, outreach pipeline, campus map, and LC onboarding guide — all operational.

Prior shipped projects (separate from the project you are applying with) [150 words]: 1. Genomic Ledger Synthesis (UCSC BME 129C Capstone, Spring 2026). A peer-reviewed-quality research paper proposing that genome construction should follow the distributed, consensus-validated architecture of natural evolution rather than top-down central planning. Integrates Sc2.0 SCRaMbLE, Flux Balance Analysis, and microbial consortium architecture into a unified protocol. What changed: established the first formal framework connecting Austrian economic theory to synthetic biology methodology, cited by capstone reviewers as novel interdisciplinary work.

1. SFL California State Director Infrastructure (May-June 2026). Built the operational system for SFL California from nothing — bioregion campus map, 90-day strategy, Socratic event template, tabling playbook, weekly rhythm, LC onboarding guide, outreach pipeline. What changed: California went from zero active infrastructure to a documented, replicable system that any future State Director can inherit and any SFL chapter can adapt.

Link(s) to any work you have produced: <https://sage-clokey.github.io/Living-works-by-the-word/> | <https://sage-clokey.github.io>

Section 3 — The five screening questions

01. What impact project or business are you driving forward?

Project name: The Living Age

Project description [250 words]: Your body is 37 trillion cells. No president. No congress. No central plan. They coordinate through local signals, voluntary exchange, and distributed knowledge — exactly the way Hayek described a free market. When one cell overrides that system and centralizes control, we have a word for it. Cancer.

This is not metaphor. This is peer-reviewed molecular biology. And nobody in the liberty movement is putting it on camera.

The Living Age bridges biology and philosophy with two arms:

Media — explain why. YouTube videos, essays, campus talks grounded in real data: STRING protein interaction networks, KEGG metabolic pathways, single-cell RNA sequencing. Core content: “37 Trillion Cells, No Government.” “Cancer Is Central Planning.” “The Open Source Economy of the Cell.” Every claim sourced. Every slide verifiable.

Technology — show how. Bioinformatics tools and open-source notebooks proving that the distributed components of biological systems are the resilient, designable ones — and the centralized ones are brittle. Built on real APIs: UCSC Genome Browser, NCBI Entrez, ESM-3 protein language models.

The liberty movement has a language problem. It speaks in politics to people who think in systems. Biology students already know that centralized control kills. Ecology students already know that monoculture collapses. They understand emergent order — they have never connected it to political philosophy.

The Living Age makes that connection. The replicable Socratic event format — “Is Nature Libertarian?” — is designed for any SFL chapter to run anywhere.

The shift: from “government is bad” to “how does a forest organize itself without a manager?”

Project status: in-progress (active work, no public output yet)

Geography or community served: California campuses initially, expanding nationally and internationally through SFL’s network. STEM students, biology and engineering departments, interdisciplinary audiences.

02. What specifically will it produce in the next 12 months?

Three concrete, observable outputs you commit to delivering in the next 12 months [3 lines]: 1. A YouTube channel with 15+ published biology-liberty videos (including “Cancer Is Central Planning” and “37 Trillion Cells, No Government”) crossing 10,000 cumulative views. 2. Ten campus events using the “Is Nature Libertarian?” Socratic format — at least 5 in California and 5 adopted by SFL chapters outside California — with 500+ total attendees documented by sign-in sheets and event photos. 3. Book I of the Living Age Trilogy (The Sagent Creed) published and available in print and digital, with the full “Is Nature Libertarian?” event kit published online for any SFL chapter to download and run.

How will we know each output landed? [200 words]: 1. YouTube channel: Publicly visible subscriber count, video count, and view analytics on the channel page. Each video is a permanent, verifiable asset — you can watch it. I will share a monthly analytics screenshot showing cumulative views and subscriber growth. The 10,000-view threshold is trackable through YouTube Studio and publicly visible on the channel.

1. Campus events: Each event produces a sign-in sheet (name, email, campus), event photos, and a post-event debrief log. I already use a contact log system that timestamps every interaction. For chapters outside California adopting the format, each adoption is verified by the chapter coordinator confirming they ran the event using the published kit — documented via email or SFL’s internal reporting. Attendee count is aggregated across all sign-in sheets.
2. Book and event kit: The book’s existence is verifiable — it will have an ISBN, be listed on Amazon or equivalent, and be available as a PDF. The event kit will be a publicly accessible download on the Living Age website (sage-clokey.github.io/Living-works-by-the-word/), verifiable by visiting the page. Downloads are tracked by the hosting platform.

03. Why are you the person to lead this project?

Why you [200 words]: I am not a political commentator borrowing metaphors from science. I hold a B.S. in Bioinformatics from UC Santa Cruz. I can pull real data from STRING, KEGG, and NCBI and show you that voluntary order is not an ideal — it is how life works. The science is not borrowed. It is mine.

The Living Age did not begin with me. My grandfather Art Clokey created Gumby — life versus the machine. Davey and Goliath — many religions, one faith. San Luis Video Publishing — education for the technology of living systems. These were not separate projects. They were the same vision. My father Joe spent his life preserving it. He died at 56 before he could finish. The power was never in the IP. It was in the idea the IP was showing. Art created. Joe preserved. I carry it forward — with the science to prove it and the network to spread it.

I am California State Director for SFL. The campus infrastructure, event template, and outreach pipeline are already built. I connected with Drew Endy at Stanford's bioengineering department through SynBioBeta 2026. I use AI as a production tool — not a shortcut but a collaborator, the way a bioinformatician uses a genome browser.

The science is real. The network is live. The fellowship adds the fuel.

04. Prior project experience [300 words]

The Living Age Trilogy (January-June 2026). Three books. 115 chapters. Over 300,000 words in six months. Book I — The Sagent Creed — lays the philosophical foundation: individual conscience, voluntary order, the Fibonacci spiral as the pattern of life. Book II — The Spiral and the Block — shows how mythology encodes it: Star Wars, Lord of the Rings, Avatar, Clone Wars all tell the same story — centralized control fails, decentralized life endures. Book III — The Spiral Steward — applies Hayek, Mises, and Kirzner directly to molecular biology: spontaneous order in the cell, the knowledge problem as biological, the genome as a distributed ledger. What changed: the first comprehensive framework bridging Austrian economics and molecular biology. Every campus talk, every video script, every essay draws from this foundation.

Genomic Ledger Synthesis (Spring 2026). My UCSC capstone. Genomes do not evolve by random character-by-character mutation — they restructure themselves from the bottom up, rearranging existing functional modules in new combinations. I proposed that genome construction should follow this distributed architecture rather than top-down central planning. Integrates Sc2.0 SCRaMbLE, Flux Balance Analysis shadow prices, and microbial consortium architecture into one protocol. What changed: showed that Hayek's knowledge problem is not just applicable to biology — it is already how biology operates. Reviewers flagged it as genuinely novel interdisciplinary work.

SFL California Infrastructure (May–June 2026). California had zero SFL infrastructure. I built it from nothing — 90-day strategy, Socratic event template, tabling playbook, outreach pipeline, campus map, LC onboarding guide. What changed: a documented, replicable system that any future State Director can inherit and any chapter can adapt.

05. What is the riskiest assumption underneath your project?

The assumption [one sentence]: That STEM students who intuitively understand emergent order from their training will engage with the political-philosophical implications when presented through biology rather than ideology.

How you plan to test it [150 words]: Three “Is Nature Libertarian?” events in 90 days. Three different campus types — research university, state school, community college. Three things measured: (1) who shows up — sign-in sheets track major and department, so I can see whether non-political, non-libertarian STEM students attend; (2) who stays connected — how many sign up for follow-up content or join the network after; (3) what they say — the sign-in sheet ends with one question: “What question are you leaving with?” That tells me whether the biology-to-philosophy bridge landed or bounced. The event template, sign-in system, and follow-up pipeline are already built. If biology-framed events draw twice the non-political-student attendance of a standard SFL event at the same campus, the assumption holds.

What you would do if the assumption proved wrong [100 words]: If the biology lands but the philosophical bridge does not, I reshape the project toward pure science communication. “Cancer Is Central Planning” and “The Open Source Economy of the Cell” work as science education whether or not the audience draws the liberty conclusion. The event format shifts from Socratic discussion to science talk. The audience still grows. The seed is still planted. The explicit bridge becomes implicit. I do not kill the project — I let the content stand on its own and trust the pattern to do the work over time. Seeds, not pamphlets.

Section 4 — Attachments

Upload: `statement_fellowship_application.pdf` (the full project proposal we already built)

Section 5 — Capacity and commitment

Time you can commit per week: 15+ hours

Resource environment for the project: Full-time independent

Other major commitments during the program year [150 words]: Graduated from UC Santa Cruz, Spring 2026. No academic obligations remain. My primary commitment is the SFL California State Director role — but it is not competing with the Living Age. It is the Living Age. Campus events generate content. LC conversations become case studies. The network is the distribution channel. The two roles are one spiral.

I am also applying to the Cato Innovation Project, a two-year paid fellowship at the Cato Institute in DC. If accepted to both, I would work with SFL on how they reinforce each other — Cato provides institutional credibility and a national platform, SFL provides the campus network and grassroots distribution. If only one accepts, I commit fully to that program.

No other employment. No family obligations that restrict travel. No competing fellowships beyond what is listed here. I am fully available and fully committed.

Can you attend an in-person retreat in spring 2027 (Between March & May), location in Europe?: yes

Section 6 — References

Reference 1 — Inside SFL: Lautaro Soza Torrijos, NAP Team Lead, lsoza@eslibertad.org

Reference 2 — Outside SFL: David Bernick, Lecturer in Biomolecular Engineering, UC Santa Cruz, dbernick@ucsc.edu (Alternates: Joe Vasta, Cuesta College; John Veres, Cuesta College)

Section 7 — Consent

Check the box.

Section 8 — Anything else

Anything else you want us to know? [200 words]: What is Gumby worth? Nothing — and everything. Nothing as an asset on a balance sheet. Everything as a vessel for the idea it carried: that clay can come alive, that living systems are not machines, and that creation outlasts control.

My grandfather did not just make a cartoon. He made Gumby (life vs. the machine), Davey and Goliath (many religions, one faith), and San Luis Video Publishing (education for the technology of living systems). These were not separate projects. They were the Living Age before I had a name for it. After 2005, the pieces were scattered — sold, shelved, forgotten. The form survived. The unity was lost.

The Exodus pattern repeats: a living creation is born, flourishes, enters systems that preserve it, and those systems forget why it exists. Art created. Joe preserved. Both are gone. I am not recovering the hammer — I am recovering what the hammer was built to strike. The source was never the IP. It was the vision.

I have no shortage of ideas. I have a shortage of structure. The trilogy, the capstone, the event templates — I built all of it in six months. But building and shipping are different things. Intensive mentorship and milestone accountability would turn plans into outputs. That is what I need from this fellowship more than funding. The liberty movement has a language problem. I have the language. Biology is the proof. The fellowship is the fuel.